

1946, October 9th

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the
Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M.Cap.

October 9th 1946.

Mr. Joseph J. O'Donnell.
Casa de Palmas Hotel
McAllen, Texas.

St. Felix Friary
Huntington, Ind.

My Dear Friend Joseph:

God bless you and yours. Many thanks for your kind favor - rather from Win-Chicago via Texas reenforce by Joe., just noted. I do hope that things brighten up before the week is over and that you return to the temperat zone relieved and at least content if not satisfied with the outcome of your, more or less force visitation. It almost seems too bad that it was not a couple months later, so that you might escape some of the probably cold months we are likely to be in for before the ripening of the next oranges, etc.

At all events try and shake of as much as you can of that over-due worry, so common to Chinese, etc business-men - like the O'Donnells and Kcs, O'Caseys and Mulligans, etc.

We are having quite ideal days here in the vicinity of the Wabash and Maumee "water-shed the one heading for the S-West to the great Gulf, the other North-east to the Great lakes and the shrines of Mont Reall, Qubec and across the briney Atlantic, etc. I sometimes imagine I'd like to follow them - as when a small child, when I was wont to coach little bark "boats" down the rills of melting snows to bigger ravines and deeper waters, - forgetting all about soaked shoes and torn trouser and often thinking of my soul's journey to eternity. What happy days those! Why? I suppose because we knew nothing of sin and worry, and everything waiving to the wupernatural. Still, as dear Mother remarked on the occasion of her golden wedding when talking about events and places familiar fort and more and less back some one remarked: "Wouldnt it be nice if we could go back to those days?", Mother answered as half to herself: "Thanks be to God, I'm glad its over." I thought afterwards, in fact it there was something in her voice that seemed to reinvision the trials of those pioneer days in West Sisconsin - happy as it was for the youngsters - as days of trials and struggles outweighing the pleasures, save that she was doing God's holy will, doing something for God and humanity and in hopes of brighter days as the years ripened for her promising family that she was then coaching on the one great pilgrimage to eternity.

The peace that still still hovers on her brow - photo on that occasion of her golden wedding - bespeaks ~~the~~ something of joy in her soul at the remembrance of those day of trials for her as well as something of the confidence that filled her heart - confidence - that she had tried at least not in vain, to come up to ideal of raising a family for God and His Church.